



POLICY

Medication: Antimicrobial Prescribing and Stewardship

Scope (Staff):	North Metropolitan Health Service Mental Health (NMHS MH) – Clinical Staff
Scope (Area):	NMHS MH – All Sites

1. Aim

This document provides a systematic approach for NMHS MH staff to optimise the correct use of antimicrobials in order to reduce inappropriate use, improve patient outcomes, reduce adverse consequences and ensure cost-effective therapy.

2. Risk

Inappropriate antimicrobial use may result in adverse sequelae including antimicrobial resistance, secondary infections and toxicity.

Governance & Accountability	☒	Policy & Legislative Compliance	☒
	☐	Quality of Patient Care	☒

3. Definitions

Antimicrobials: include antibiotics or antibacterials, antivirals, antifungals, antiseptics and antiparasitics.

4. Principles

Antimicrobial use among NMHS MH inpatient units will be governed by antimicrobial stewardship principles in accordance with the [WA Statewide Medicines Formulary Policy](#).

Antimicrobial agents **will not** be prescribed at NMHS MH Community Clinics.

4.1 Formulary

All antimicrobial prescribing within NMHS MH are to meet restrictions set out in the [WA Statewide Medicines Formulary](#) (SMF).

4.2 Prescribing

Antimicrobial prescribing will follow the principles of use of antimicrobials as per the current version of Therapeutic Guidelines: Antibiotic® ([eTG: Antibiotic](#)) and according to the restrictions and requirement stated by the SMF.

Prescribing outside the guidelines and/or SMF requires prior approval by a clinical microbiologist or an infectious disease physician. A non-formulary form must be completed as per the Medication – Formulary & Non-Formulary Prescribing policy ([NMHS MH Medication: Formulary & Non-Formulary Prescribing](#))

Factors to consider prior to prescribing any antimicrobial agent:

- M** microbiology guides therapy (where possible)
- I** indications should be evidence based
- N** narrowest spectrum required
- D** dosage appropriate to the site and type of infection
- M** minimise duration of therapy
- E** ensure monotherapy (wherever possible).

Documentation on the patient's medication chart and in the patient's integrated notes should include:

- the antimicrobial name
- indication
- dose
- frequency
- route
- intended duration or review plan for the antimicrobial.

This should also be documented in the patient's discharge summary.

Information is to be given to the patient regarding their condition and treatment.

4.3 Inventory Management

Unrestricted antibiotics may be kept as part of the ward imprest on inpatient units as appropriate.

Restricted antibiotics will only be provided with a documented approval from a clinical microbiologist or infectious disease physician.

5. Compliance and Evaluation

- Prescribers will be informed of the antimicrobial stewardship policy at orientation.
- Antimicrobial Stewardship will be managed by the NMHS MH Drug and Therapeutics Committee (DTC).
- NMHS MH DTC will monitor the use of antimicrobial agents of interest to ensure referral by a clinical microbiologist or infectious disease physician and report to the Head of Clinical Service for the site.
- Audit results will be reported to NMHS MH DTC, NMHS MH Infection Prevention and Control Committee and the Clinical Governance Committee quarterly.
- NMHS MH does not participate in the National Antimicrobial Utilisation Surveillance Program or the National Antimicrobial Prescribing Survey as these programs focus on restricted and injectable antimicrobials which are not used in NMHS MH.

6. Performance Indicators

- 100% prescriptions for antimicrobials comply with this policy.
- 100% of prescriptions for restricted antibiotics have prior documented approval by a clinical microbiologist or infectious disease physician.

Related internal policies, procedures and guidelines

[NMHS MH Medication: Prescribing, Administration and Management for Inpatients](#)

[NMHS MH Medication: Formulary & Non-Formulary Prescribing](#)

[NMHS MH Medication: Management of High Risk Medication](#)

References

[ACSQHC Antimicrobial Stewardship in Australian Health Care](#)

[ACSQHC Antimicrobial Stewardship Clinical Care Standard](#)

[ACSQHC National Safety and Quality Health Care Standards 2nd ed](#)

[WA Antimicrobial Stewardship Guidance Document](#)

[Statewide Medicines Formulary Policy \(MP0077/18\)](#)

[WA Statewide Medicines Formulary Policy](#)

Useful resources (including related forms)

[Australian Prescriber: Antimicrobial stewardship: what's it all about?](#)

Policy Sponsor	NMHS MH Chief Pharmacist				
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NSQHS Standards Applicable:	☒  Std 1: Clinical Governance ☒  Std 3: Preventing and Controlling Healthcare Associated Infection		☒  Std 4: Medication Safety		
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Document Version Control			
Date	Version	Author	Notes
18/06/2013	V1	NMHS MH DTC	Meeting Minutes 0613/5
02/08/2016	V1.1	NMHS MH DTC	
5/12/2019	V2	A/Chief Pharmacist NMHS MH	Updated document to reflect change of local formulary to SMF and to conform to current policy template.
14/11/2022	V3	NMHS MH Chief Pharmacist	Updated template; hyperlinks reviewed; added definition of antimicrobials

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